

Neighborhood Watch - Block Captain Checklist

Block Captain Contact Information

Name: _____
Phone: _____
Email: _____

Getting Started

Define the boundaries of my block or neighborhood.
Register the group with the local Neighborhood Watch or police contact, if required.
Build a roster of residents and households.
Collect preferred contact methods for each resident.
Identify a backup block captain or alternate contact.
Create a safe and secure place to store contact information.

Communication

Set up a phone tree, text group, or email list.
Share official crime prevention updates with residents.
Keep messages factual, brief, and respectful.
Update contact lists when residents move in or out.
Welcome new neighbors and explain the program.
Share emergency contact numbers with residents.

Legal and Community Standards

Protect privacy and handle information responsibly.
Avoid bias, profiling, or discrimination.
Respect property rights and local laws.
Keep communication factual, respectful, and calm.
Work within Neighborhood Watch guidelines.

Meetings and Outreach

Schedule at least one neighborhood meeting each year.
Prepare a simple agenda for each meeting.
Invite new residents and encourage participation.
Share crime prevention tips during meetings.
Encourage neighbors to get to know one another.
Plan a social event such as National Night Out, a block party, or a porch gathering.
Record attendance and items.
Follow up on action items after meetings.

Crime Prevention

Share home security tips with residents.
Encourage use of lights, locks, and visibility around homes.
Promote package theft prevention and vehicle safety.
Remind neighbors to report suspicious activity.
Encourage residents to watch for unusual behavior, not to investigate it.
Share seasonal safety reminders.

Observation and Reporting

Know when to call 911 versus the non-emergency number.
Teach residents to observe and report from a safe place.
Remind everyone not to confront suspects.
Record useful details when safe to do so, such as vehicle description, direction of travel, and time.
Keep a log of concerns, incidents, and follow-up actions.
Share relevant information with the appropriate public safety contact.

Emergency Preparedness

Share basic emergency preparedness information.
Encourage household emergency plans.
Identify residents who may need extra support during emergencies.
Share evacuation, shelter-in-place, and utility outage guidance.
Keep emergency contact information current.
Confirm where residents can find official alerts.

Leadership and Administration

Keep the group organized and active.
Recruit and support volunteers.
Delegate tasks when needed.
Prevent burnout by sharing responsibilities.
Maintain a simple record of meetings, contacts, and incidents.
Review and refresh the group plan regularly.
Identify a successor or alternate captain.
Prepare a transition packet for the next block captain.

Safety and Boundaries

Stay at a safe distance from suspicious activity.
Never detain, chase, or investigate suspected offenders.
Avoid arguments, confrontation, or escalation.
Respect privacy and confidentiality.
Follow anti-discrimination and respectful conduct guidelines.
Work within the law at all times.

Technology and Digital Safety

Use secure messaging and email practices.
Warn neighbors about scams, phishing, and fake alerts.
Handle photos and video responsibly.
Keep digital contact lists protected.
Avoid spreading unverified information online.

Ongoing Duties

Keep the resident roster updated.
Welcome new neighbors and share program information.
Share official crime-prevention alerts or updates.
Maintain phone tree, text list, or email list.
Encourage residents to report suspicious activity.
Keep notes on neighborhood concerns or incidents.
Protect resident contact information.

Monthly Review

Review the contact list.
Confirm backup captain coverage.
Send a neighborhood update.
Check for new residents.
Review recent concerns or incidents.
Refresh safety reminders.

Annual Review

Hold a neighborhood meeting or event.
Review the group's goals and structure.
Update emergency and contact information.
Evaluate what worked well this year.
Identify training needs for next year.
Confirm who will serve as block captain and alternate.